Hycient Igweze

Senior Full-Stack & ML Engineer

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Full-stack engineer with 7+ years building production systems in fintech, payments, health and government, now focused on AI products and ML. At Whiteshield I work on national platforms for the UAE, including UAE Skills, where I wrote the skills and course recommendation model, and the EduHub admissions portal. Before that I built payment infrastructure for PayS ($30M+ processed a month, 500,000+ active users) and led mobile for a multi-currency crypto exchange. I design AI systems where the model proposes and deterministic code decides, and I evaluate models in ways that don't flatter them.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, Python, Dart

Front end & mobile: React, Next.js, React Native, Flutter, Tailwind CSS

Back end & data: Node.js, NestJS, .NET, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Prisma, GraphQL

ML & AI: LLM agents (LangGraph, Claude API, Zod structured outputs), recommendation models, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, data pipelines, leakage-safe evaluation

Cloud & delivery: AWS, Azure, Railway, Cloudflare, CI/CD, TDD

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer · Whiteshield · Remote — Jan 2025 – Present

- Build AI-powered national platforms for UAE government clients as part of Whiteshield's delivery teams, across Next.js, TypeScript and .NET (C#).
- **UAE Skills** (MoHRE & MoHESR): worked across the full platform, a web, iOS and Android service linking labour-market demand, graduate outcomes and enrolment. Wrote the skills and course recommendation model behind the student experience.
- **EduHub** (MoHESR): part of the team that developed the national admissions and scholarship portal, with 74 institutions registered. Its AI-enhanced scholarship flow cut applications from 22 form fields to four.
- Built an AI job-listing and candidate-matching system for 5,000+ users, cutting job-description drafting time by about 70%.
- Work with policy and economics teams across four continents to turn strategy into production software that meets public-sector QA standards.

Software Engineer · Sahara Group (PayS) · Remote — Oct 2023 – Sep 2025

- Built core services for PayS, an energy and utility payments platform whose largest client is Ikeja Electric, processing $30M+ a month for 500,000+ active users.
- Built the receipt service behind every transaction (single, e-bill and bulk payments) and the customer portal for bills and meter payments.
- Built an in-house CDN on AWS S3 with Node.js and TypeScript, shared across the group's products.
- Led the PayS Store multi-vendor marketplace (1,000+ vendors) and the Flutter mobile app for electricity tokens, airtime and bills.

Lead Mobile Engineer · CloudP2P (Cloudax) · Remote — Aug 2022 – Oct 2023

- Led the mobile team for a peer-to-peer crypto exchange and shipped two major versions with multi-currency and cross-chain trading, escrowed trades, trader ratings and dispute resolution.
- Owned the app architecture and business logic, and set the team's code-review standard and release process.

Lead Frontend Engineer · Pluralcode · Remote — May 2022 – Jul 2023

- Ran the learning platform serving 10,000+ learners a month and maintained the ACHAN airport car-hire booking system (3,000+ customers and providers).
- Built an e-commerce API in Node.js with a React front end, and mentored cohorts of new engineers in JavaScript and React.

Freelance & Contract Engineer 2018 – 2022

- Node.js commerce APIs (Wetfire), a React storefront (Adehot), React Native fintech apps (Vision Savings, Tranxnow), DeFi lending flows (Vilo), a component library (Groomlog) and iOS telehealth apps for patients and doctors (myhealthXP).

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Handshake Agent** · NestJS, Next.js, LangGraph, Claude, Prisma, PostgreSQL
  Chat-native crypto and payments agent where the LLM cannot move money. Its only output is a validated Zod intent with no destination field. A deterministic engine re-derives every amount, re-runs KYC, velocity and sanctions checks at settlement, and executes only with a PIN and a single-use HMAC grant on a BigInt double-entry ledger. About 78 lines of LLM code against 3,000 of engine. Write-up · github.com/emeraldhycient/handshake-agent
- **Credit scoring on African loan data** · scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras
  68,000 loans with a 1.8% default rate. Customer-grouped splits, history features built only from earlier loans, PR-AUC instead of accuracy. A tuned Random Forest (PR-AUC 0.936, 92% recall at 77% precision) beat a wide & deep network, with the gap confirmed by a customer-level bootstrap.
- **Malaria detection CNN** · TensorFlow/Keras, MobileNetV2
  Lightweight model for blood-smear images, split by source photo to prevent leakage: 95.6% sensitivity, 96.5% specificity and 0.991 ROC-AUC on 4,105 held-out cells.
- **Multimodal identity & recommendation pipeline** · Python, team project
  Built the execution layer that chains face recognition, voice verification and product recommendation models into one gated flow. github.com/hycienti/Multimodal-Data-Preprocessing
- **NexusWait** · React, Vite, Tailwind CSS
  Waitlist SaaS with hosted pages, form integrations (Mailchimp, Slack, HubSpot, Zapier and more) and a REST API with SDKs. nexuswait.com

VENTURES

- **PlumAutomate**, founder: software and automation studio. Work includes the Zentry ticket marketplace (web, iOS and Android; 10,000+ users and 100,000+ tickets in its first year), a cross-border settlement API for Handshake, and Blimdata's medical-imaging pipeline (PACS gateway, DICOM de-identification, radiologist annotation). plumautomate.com
- **Moving Man Logistics**, co-founder & CEO: on-demand delivery and rides in Kigali, Rwanda.
- **EcoRed**, co-founder: SON-certified low-carbon laterite cement and bricks for affordable housing in Nigeria.

EDUCATION & SPEAKING

- **African Leadership University**: BSc, Machine Learning & Computer Science (in progress).
- Guest speaker, University of Greenwich International College (2026): "What it means to be an engineer when AI can write the code".